BB Curve 9315 released

BlackBerry 7.1 OS based Curve 9315was recently released. There is no word about its availability in India though

Consoles launch in March?

According to reports, both Microsoft and Sony are planning to reveal their next-gen consoles in March this year

testing parameters topped out at ISO 6400, as that was the maximum for most cameras. The G1x's APS-C sized sensor didn't have a lot of problem keeping the noise at bay. The RX100 was a very close second, given that it also has a large, 1-inch sensor. However, the real surprise here was the Fujifilm X10, which despite its smaller sensor was nearly at par with the RX100.

We measured the detail retained in the toy fibers and bottle label from our test scene at every ISO level. Once again, the larger sensor on the G1x put it ahead of the competition, with Sony's 20 megapixel, 1-inch BSI sensor not far behind. The Nikons, obviously, with their tiny little sensors, couldn't keep up with the front runners, but the Nikon Coolpix P7700 showed a surprising penchant for detail retention, at least when shooting RAW. If we were to leave ISO out of the equation and put the cameras in aperture priority mode, then we noticed the G1x falter slightly. With an aperture of f/2.8, the camera couldn't achieve fast shutter speeds, which made shooting a person walking slowly quite a challenging image to capture. The LX7 on the other hand didn't have any issues with capturing the image, but it did have a hard time locking focus. The G15 on the other hand did really well thanks to the fast, f/1.8 lens, but the real star of the show was the Sony RX100, which managed to lock focus and shoot at high ISO and give us decent enough shutter speed to capture our subject. Switching to the bright daylight conditions, the rules of physics were quite apparent. Larger sensors captured more dynamic range and displayed better color depth when compared to their small sensor-ed counterparts. Once

Fujifilm-X10

again, the G1x shone bright here, with the Sony RX100 in close tow.

Verdict

Canon Powershot G1x is the winner of our **Best Performer** award and therefore the point and shoot for you to buy. However, before you shell out the ₹48,000 premium for it, do note that you can buy a decent DSLR for that price, a DSLR which will give you the option to change and use far better lenses that those on the G1x. Instead, if you turn to the Sony DSC RX100, which performs almost as well as the G1x, you'd realize that for ₹34, 990, it's a far better deal. Given the amazing blend of performance and price the **Sony RX100** truly deserves the **Best Buy** award. While the RX100 and the G1x wear the winner's crown, we can't help but make a special mention of the Fujifilm X10. Its an incredibly beautiful camera with a great AF system, amazing imaging performance and a whole load of old-school dials. It doesn't perform quite as well as the G1x, and it's a lot more expensive than the RX100, so it loses out on the two logical metrics, but despite that, the **Fujifilm X10** has impressed us enough for it to earn our **Editor's Pick** award.

Canon PowerShot G1X

Basic point and shoot cameras

Now that we've got the bigwigs out of the way, we can focus on the smaller, more basic point-n-shoot cameras that we got. For this category, we restricted the models to those that fell below a price cap of ₹15,000 and only included those that were released after October 2012.

Features and design

In this matchup, we've got three compact point and shoot cameras: The Nikon Coolpix S8200, Fujifilm F660 EXR and the BenQ GH210 and two ultra-zoom cameras: the Nikon Coolpix L610 and the BenQ GH650.

The GH650 offers the maximum zoom in this category, with the lens capable of pulling off shots in the 22-580 mm range. We were actually quite surprised to see the lens go down to 22 mm, something we have not seen in a lot of point and shoot cameras as they generally tend to favor 24 or 28 mm as a starting point.

The Nikon Coolpix S8200 and the BenQ GH210 ship with a very standard set of features, f/3.5-5.8 aperture lens, a focal length of roughly 25-350 mm and a 1/2.3-inch sensor , but the shocker on the GH210 is that it uses a CCD sensor, a type that is now being phased out by most manufacturers. However, it's interesting to note that the BenQ site lists the sensor on the GH210 as one made by Sony, while the one on the GH650 as made by Panasonic. Similarly, the optics on the BenQ cameras also come from Sony, although we have serious doubts whether these optics match the quality found on Sony's own cameras.

The Fujifilm F660 EXR uses an unconventionally sized 1/2-inch sensor, making it the largest amongst those we compared. Other than that, it also has some rather nice ergonomics, with smooth curves and a well finished body, but the real winner for us is the mode-dial which is placed at a slight angle on